

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

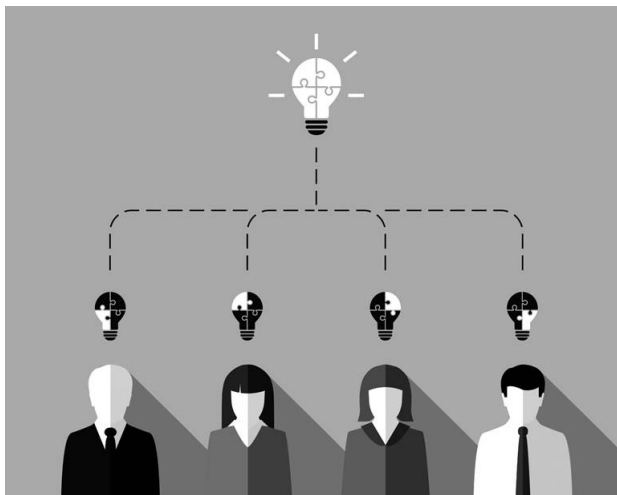
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Let's Start!

We got it right this time!



Learning Outcome

Understand actions, events, and experiences in present, past or future and in spoken or written texts and in work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- What improvements have you made at work?
- What did they help you do better?
- What other improvements would you like to make?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about the present result of events that started in the past in work and job issues.
- I can discuss reasons and results of an event or an action related to work and jobs.
- I can explain arguments supporting different points of view.





Let's Explore!

Boris and Denise talk about the monthly sales report. Good news!



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Boris: Have you studied the monthly sales report, Denise?

Denise: No, how does it look?

Boris: It would appear that your sales pitch has finally taken off. We have seen a 200% increase in sales in the financial literacy workbooks since last month. Excellent!

Denise:

Boris: This is more good news. The marketing department has informed me that the number of requests for presentations has increased dramatically. There is also a message from a local bank president who has expressed an interest in becoming a corporate sponsor.

Denise: That's great news.

Boris: You know, it would be a good idea to evaluate our strategies. What worked well? What didn't work very well? What changes to the pitch or other factors made a difference?

Denise: Yes. That's a good idea, because talking about it now will help me give feedback at the next board meeting.

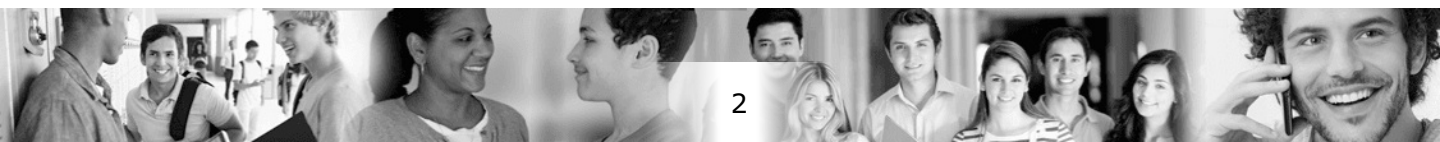
Boris: From my perspective, I think we have had more success through the direct marketing approach. We were more successful when we contacted the end users -- the parents or teachers -- not the bureaucrats in the school board or the Department of Education.

Denise: I agree. We also have been more successful since I worked on the pitch. I geared it towards the specific needs of the consumer, rather than to our own track record. People became enthusiastic because I was able to summarize their problems even before they had the chance to express them.

Boris: We explained "the fit".

Denise: Right. It seems our investment in focus groups has helped a lot to understand the market.

Boris: Although direct marketing is powerful, don't forget that we combined that with our online campaign including podcasts and using social media. Our Twitter feed is a lot more active than before, because people are asking questions and engaging in conversation directly with the authors.





Let's Practice!

Toby discusses reasons and results of events.

*Instructions: Complete the sentences. Use **since** or **because**. Practice saying the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.*

1. People became enthusiastic _____ I was able to summarize their problems even before they had the chance to express them.
2. That's a good idea, _____ talking about it now will help me give feedback at the next board meeting.
3. _____ the campaign is finished now, it would be a good idea to evaluate our strategies.
4. _____ the sales pitch is so good now, we can expect more success in the future.
5. Our Twitter feed is a lot more active than before, _____ people are asking questions and engaging in conversation directly with the authors.



Let's Practice!

Denise reports news about the sales campaign*.

*The word "*campaign*" is pronounced like cam-pein. You do not hear the g.

Instructions: Proofread the sentences. Cross out the incorrect words. Write the correct words on the line. Use the sentences to model a conversation with your partner. Switch roles.

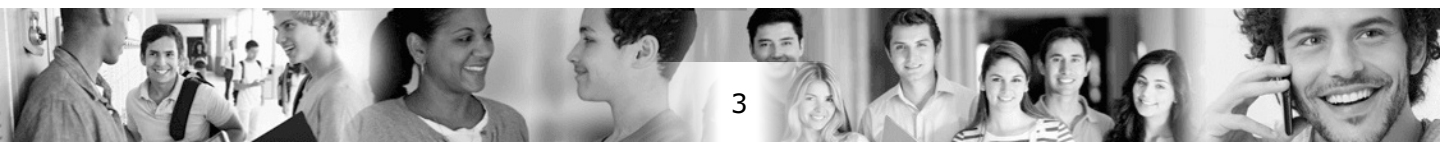
1. It appear that the number of requests for presentations have increased dramatically.

2. It seemed a local bank president has express an interest in becoming a corporate sponsor.

3. It has sounded like we have have more success through the direct marketing approach.

4. It seeming our investment in focus groups have helped a lot to understand the market.

5. It would appears that your sales pitch has finally take off.





Extension Activity

Make suggestions to improve sales in a business meeting.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Make a list of the sales strategies mentioned in this lesson.
- With a partner, discuss other sales strategies. Add them to your list.
- Go online. Add more ideas to your list. Try to come up with a total of 10 ideas.
- Do a role-play of a business meeting. Give the ideas as ways to improve sales.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I write a list of strategies to improve sales.

☐ ☐

I read and discuss strategies to improve sales.

☐ ☐

I give suggestions for sales in a role-play of a business meeting.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- fit** (noun): connection between a product and the needs of a customer
e.g. We explained "the fit" with our product.
- corporate sponsor** (noun): a large company who pays money to be associated with an event or a product
e.g. There is also a message from a local bank president who has expressed an interest in becoming a corporate sponsor.
- bureaucrat** (noun): a person who works for a government institution
e.g. We were more successful when we contacted the end users, not the bureaucrats in the school board.
- school board** (noun): in North America, a way of organizing schools into districts with local control
e.g. There are twenty-five school boards in our state.
- end user** (noun): the person or group who will buy and use a product or service
e.g. It's important to reach the end users of the product.
- to gear** (verb): to orient or direct something in a certain way, for a particular reason
e.g. I geared the pitch more towards the specific needs of the consumer, rather than to our own track record.
- sales report** (noun): a document outlining the revenue
e.g. Have you studied the monthly sales report, Denise?





Learning Points

The Present Perfect Tense: Commenting on Results

You use the Present Perfect tense when you want to talk about a past event that has a connection to the present.

This is especially useful when you want to talk about the present results of a past situation or event.

You can use the verbs *appear*, *seem* and *sound* to comment on the present results of something in the past.

For example:

*It **appears** as if **he has already decided** to take the job.*

*It **sounds** like **they have been** promoted to team leaders.*

*She **seems** as though **she has been** awake for days.*

Examples:

- *It would appear that your sales pitch has finally taken off.*
- *It seems our investment in focus groups has helped a lot to understand the market.*
- *It sounds like we have had more success through the direct marketing approach.*





Learning Points

Reason Clauses with Because and Since

You can introduce the reason for something happening with clauses. This makes your speaking or writing more dynamic.

You can introduce reasons with the words *because* and *since*.

Since is often placed at the beginning of a sentence. *Because* is usually placed between two clauses.

Look at the chart for details:

Word	Use	Example
<i>because</i>	to answer the question <i>Why?</i>	<i>I didn't finish the report because I had other priorities.</i>
<i>since</i>	introduces a reason that the listener or reader already knows	<i>Since</i> <i>you don't know how to use this machine, let's try something else.</i>

Examples:

- *That's a good idea, because talking about it now will help me give feedback at the next board meeting.*
- *Since the sales pitch is so good now, we can expect more success in the future.*
- *People became enthusiastic because I was able to summarize their problems even before they had the chance to express them.*

